

A Briefing for the Jamaat Body

A plain-language overview for the committee: what it is, how it works, who runs it, what it costs, and what we need you to decide.

IN ONE LINE

One shared web link that gives any travelling member a trusted local jamaat contact, the masjid, and somewhere to stay — in any city across India. No app to install, no login. It is already built and running as a working prototype for the body to review.

THE NEED

When our members travel to an unfamiliar city, finding a reliable local jamaat contact, the nearest masjid, or a musafir khana to stay in still depends on word-of-mouth and personal networks. Newcomers and younger travellers often have neither. This directory turns that scattered knowledge into one trusted, always-available reference — pan-India from day one, with no city treated as the default.

HOW IT WORKS

The whole system is three plain steps. The community keeps it up to date; a jamaat moderator keeps it trustworthy.

- 1. Anyone contributes** — A community member fills in a short Google Form to add a contact, a masjid, a place to stay, or to report/remove an entry. No account, no app.
- 2. A moderator reviews** — A named jamaat volunteer checks the entry in a familiar Google Sheet — the same as reviewing a spreadsheet. Nothing goes live until they approve it. No developer is needed.
- 3. It appears on the website** — Approved entries show up on the public directory. A traveller opens one link, searches a city, and finds a local contact, the masjid, and somewhere to stay.

WHO RUNS IT

Day-to-day moderation happens in an ordinary Google Sheet, so a non-technical jamaat volunteer can approve an entry or fix a typo without a developer. The website itself is hosted on Cloudflare and needs no servers to maintain. In short: the community contributes, named moderators approve, and the site runs itself. All it needs from the body is oversight — and the moderators to staff it.

PRIVACY & SAFETY

Protecting members' contact details was a first-class design goal, built into the system — not an afterthought.

- ✓ **Phone numbers are never published in bulk.** They are shown one at a time, only when a visitor taps “Show number”, protected by a bot check and rate limiting.
- ✓ **Consent is required.** A contact is only listed with the person's consent, and anyone can report or remove their own entry at any time.
- ✓ **Moderated.** Only entries a moderator has marked “live” are ever shown.
- ✓ **Unlisted by default.** The site currently ships unlisted — it is not found on Google — until the body decides the access posture.

WHAT IT COSTS

₹0 / month to run at launch scale.

The system is designed to sit inside the free tiers of Cloudflare and Google. The only optional spending is a custom web address.

Item	Cost	Note
Website + hosting (Cloudflare)	₹0 / month	Free tier covers the expected traffic.
Contributions (Google Form + Sheet)	₹0 / month	Runs on an ordinary Google account.
Custom domain (optional)	~\$8–12 / year	Only if we want our own web address.
Extra capacity (only if very large)	~\$5 / month	Not needed at launch scale.

WHERE IT STANDS

The directory is fully built and deployed as a working prototype, loaded with sample cities so the body can see and use it today. What remains is adding real jamaat data and switching on live community contributions — which is exactly what the decisions below unlock.

WHAT WE NEED YOU TO DECIDE

Access posture — Unlisted (share by link only) or fully public (findable on Google)?

Moderators — Name at least two jamaat volunteers to review and approve entries.

Hotels & restaurants — Keep these sections in the first version, or contacts + masjids + stay only?

Web address — Do we want a custom domain name, and if so, which?

Endorsement — Formal go-ahead to launch, and any rules about what may be listed.

A live, non-technical version of this briefing is also available on the site itself at /howitworks.